

Contact

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(LinkedIn)

Top Skills

DFIR

Digital Forensics

Policy Analysis

Languages

English

Certifications

The Data Scientist's Toolbox

Quantitative Methods

Journalism, the future, and you!

Data Science @Cisco Generative AI
Green Belt 2024

Tim Shores

I make complex systems legible and trapped knowledge valuable
Leverett, Massachusetts, United States

Summary

Most useful information is stuck. It's in people's heads, buried in systems nobody reads, jargon nobody outside the room understands, or data waiting to be shaped into a decision. I've spent my career finding it and making it useful. At Cisco, that means leading content strategy and information architecture for security products — structuring technical knowledge so customers can find and act on what they need. I'm currently a member of a cross-organizational tiger team transforming Cisco's technical communications into an AI-native content system, focused on content modeling and context engineering that structure knowledge for AI reasoning and dynamic, persona-driven experiences. This builds on earlier work documenting Cisco's LLM-powered assistant feature and prototyping AI generation of identity-based technical content. Before Cisco, it meant building databases of European Parliament voting patterns for a forest policy campaign, designing donor data systems and writing program concept notes for a Haiti-focused nonprofit, and constructing the knowledge base that cut support call volume by 20% at a software company. Outside work, I serve on a planning board and two school committees in Western Massachusetts and on the board of The 'MPOWER Project. Municipal budgets, policy, and community needs all hold trapped knowledge, and the value comes when it's made legible to the people making decisions about them. My range of work is deliberate. Illegible complexity shows up everywhere, and the work of solving it transfers across contexts more than people expect. I work regularly with AI tools, Python, and open-source data as part of how I approach making institutional knowledge accessible at scale. I'm building professionally toward the intersection where structured content, AI reasoning, and human judgment work together.

Experience

Cisco

4 years 4 months

Technical Education Content Developer

May 2024 - Present (2 years 1 month)

Content strategy lead for flagship product Cisco Secure Access in close collaboration with product, engineering, UX, and CX teams. Recent work includes architecting end-to-end content strategy for Secure Access, launching a new documentation set for SASE Management, and driving quality and accuracy improvements to IPsec tunnels documentation.

Serving as a member of the Content Modeling workstream on Cisco's AI-Native Content Strategy initiative — a cross-organizational tiger team transforming Cisco content strategy, technical writing, and integration with the product experience into graphRAG-structured knowledge work. My focus is content modeling and context engineering that enable AI reasoning and dynamic, persona-driven content experiences. The broader initiative spans workstreams addressing AI-assisted authoring, intent-driven content retrieval and governance, and continuous quality improvement.

Developing information architecture expertise as a formal IA mentee, applying it to AI-ready content structures across the Secure Access product line, and leading collaborative context engineering work in support of AI tooling adoption and culture change across technical communications. Earlier work includes researching and writing documentation for the Cisco Assistant LLM feature and co-developing a hackathon proof-of-concept for LLM-generated, identity-based technical content.

Technical Communications Specialist

February 2022 - May 2024 (2 years 4 months)

Customer communications lead and content researcher for Cisco Duo on the Security Documentation team. Planned and wrote communications connecting cybersecurity product customers with what they needed to know about product changes, vulnerabilities, and required actions. Wrote release notes each sprint and coordinated customer communication impact studies with Product and Data Science teams.

Worked to extend the Duo communications model to other Cisco Security products. Facilitated discussions with SMEs across design, engineering, and product management, and contributed to content performance analysis and process improvement for the team's publishing operations.

Mentored early-career coworkers and students.

Town Common Research

Researcher

January 2022 - August 2023 (1 year 8 months)

Leverett

Community-based participatory research for towns and community organizations in Western Massachusetts. Collected and reported data for Age-Friendly needs assessments and supported equity and justice initiatives, helping local organizers build evidence-based knowledge for community-driven decision-making.

Partnership for Policy Integrity

Forest Policy Campaign Researcher

October 2019 - January 2023 (3 years 4 months)

Working to defend forests.

Researched and wrote in support of the Forest Defenders Alliance campaign to remove forest biomass from the European Union Renewable Energy Directive and end the counting of wood burning toward emissions reduction targets. Managed the campaign website and participated in outreach.

Built a database of Members of European Parliament tracking party and committee memberships and voting patterns on forests and environmental policy, supporting campaign monitoring and targeted outreach.

forestdefenders.eu

Hope for Haiti

Director of Data & Donor Experience

August 2019 - February 2022 (2 years 7 months)

Leverett, MA

Managed revenue data, grant writing, grant pipeline, and donor services for a nonprofit working to improve quality of life for the Haitian people, particularly children. Designed program concepts for Haitian farmer support initiatives

and wrote funding proposals to sustain them. Helped coordinate galas and fundraising events.

Led fundraising response through an extraordinary sequence of crises: COVID-19, civil unrest, the assassination of President Moïse, and the August 2021 earthquake.

VentureWell

Platform Analyst

November 2016 - August 2019 (2 years 10 months)

Hadley, MA

Salesforce platform lead for a nonprofit cultivating early-stage STEM ventures. First responder for development planning and implementation, second-tier resource for user support and training. Designed and built solutions supporting grants management, impact evaluation, program monitoring, digital marketing, and relationship management across funders, investors, and program participants.

Worked across Salesforce Community, Pardot, Service Cloud, Process Builder and Flow, Apex, Lightning Web Components, and Nonprofit Success Pack, integrated with NetSuite via SOAP API and supported by tools including Form Assembly, Conga Composer, and RStudio.

Not1More

Program Lead, Tech, Innovation, & Coalition Development

August 2015 - August 2019 (4 years 1 month)

Leverett, MA

Technology and coalition development for a global environmental justice organization supporting frontline forest defenders facing violence and reprisals.

Designed and deployed technology solutions for researchers and defenders in remote forest sites, including Forest Threat Sensor (peer-to-peer alerting and mapping for defenders encountering risk), TIRTL (rights violation documentation and reporting), and DefenderDirect (direct giving fundraising). Managed CRM development, data collection design, web development, and digital marketing.

Built coalition relationships and wrote for fundraising and advocacy. Supported the Forest Defenders Conference, the "I am Chut Wutty" documentary campaign, the Bloodwood report on unauthorized rosewood plunder in

Guinea-Bissau, and the Amazon Security Framework community of practice for defenders under threat in the Amazon.

Computer Courage

IT Services Manager

January 2013 - November 2014 (1 year 11 months)

Berkeley, CA

Led a team of 5 to 7 technicians serving 150 small business customers at a Berkeley IT service provider and web developer. Personally closed 30 contracts through business goal analysis, clear proposals, and reliable service.

Collaborated with the President on business operations improvements including CRM implementation, project management templates, cost forecasting, service outcome evaluation, and KPI monitoring.

DOMICO Software

Production Manager and Senior Database Specialist

June 2006 - January 2013 (6 years 8 months)

Oakland, CA

Database software company specializing in the self-storage real estate subsector. Worked on a small team supporting finance and management clients through data migrations, software customization, QA, and feature development on SQL Server.

Reduced support call volume 20% and improved resolution time 40% by mentoring technicians, constructing and managing a knowledge base, and driving process improvement and automation for QA and ETL workflows.

Borders Group Inc

Helpdesk Technician

January 1999 - September 2000 (1 year 9 months)

Ann Arbor, MI

Remote support for Windows NT and OS/2 systems across Borders and Waldenbooks stores, connected by VSAT. Supported email, inventory, and point-of-sale applications.

Education

University of Michigan

BGS, Linguistics, Philosophy, and Psychology · (September 1998 - June 2004)

University of Massachusetts Amherst
Graduate Certificate, Data Analytics and Computational Social Science
(DACSS) · (November 2022 - December 2024)